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Pet grooming and massage tool

Abstract

A hand operated pet grooming and massage tool that transitions between a grooming tool and a massaging tool based on the flex state of the hand operating the tool is disclosed herein. An example grooming tool includes a body, wing members, and a blade holder. The body is made of a deformable material configured to deform between a first position and a second position. The wing members are each connected to opposite sides of the body. The body defines a first distance between in wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position. The blade holder is connected to the body and is configured to affix to a grooming blade. When installed, the blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/211,252 entitled, “PET GROOMING AND MASSAGE TOOL,” filed Jun. 16, 2021, which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure generally relates pet grooming supplies and, more specifically, a pet grooming and massage tool.

BACKGROUND

(2) Regular grooming of an animal companion, such as a dog, is an important part maintaining the health of the animal companion. Grooming an animal companion can have numerous benefits, such as removing dead hair, stimulating and cleaning the skin, maintaining a healthy coat by helping to distribute natural oils, etc. Regular grooming can also provide an opportunity to inspect the animal companion for any potential health problems. Additionally, massaging a pet companion may provide bonding time, improve circulation, reduce stress and anxiety, and provide comfort, etc.

SUMMARY

(3) As described herein, a hand operated pet grooming and massage tool transitions between a grooming tool and a massaging tool based on the flex state of the hand operating the tool. The tool includes a blade configured to groom an animal companion. The blade is attached to a flexible body with wing members. When the user's hand is cupped, the body flexes to position the blade away from the coat of the animal companion. The wing members can then be used to massage the animal companion. When user's hand is in a flat position, the body flattens to position the blade against the coat of the animal companion. In such a manner, the user can quickly and intuitively change which action (e.g., grooming or massaging, etc.) is being performed on the animal companion. These and other features and advantages of the present disclosure are set forth in the following specification, drawings and claims.

(4) An example grooming mount includes a body, wing members, and a blade holder. The body is made of a deformable material configured to deform between a first position and a second position. Each of the wing members are connected to opposite sides of the body. The body defining a first distance between in wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position. The blade holder is connected to the body. The blade holder configured to affix to a grooming blade, wherein, when installed, the blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position.

(5) An example grooming tool includes a grooming blade, a grooming mount, and a handle. The grooming mount includes a body, wing members, and a blade holder. The body is made of a deformable material and is configured to deform between a first position and a second position. The body defines a first distance between in wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position. The blade holder is connected to the body configured to affix to the grooming blade to the grooming mount. The blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position. The handle is configured to receive a hand and is affixed to the grooming mount.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION

(1) Operation of the disclosure may be better understood by reference to the following detailed description taken in connection with the following illustrations, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of an example pet groomer, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(3) FIG. 1B illustrates the example pet groomer in use, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(4) FIG. 1C illustrates the example pet groomer is an example flat or grooming position, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(5) FIG. 1D illustrates the example pet groomer is an example cupped or massage position, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(6) FIGS. 2A, 2B, 2C, and 2D illustrate various views of an example body of a pet groomer, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(7) FIGS. 3A, 3B, 3C, and 3D illustrate various views of an example blade of the pet groomer, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(8) FIG. 4 illustrates the example blade of the example pet groomer of FIG. 5, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(9) FIGS. 5A and 5B illustrate various views of an example handle of a pet groomer, in accordance with the

teachings of this disclosure.

(10) FIGS. 6A and 6B illustrates an example of a pet groomer, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(11) FIGS. 7A, 7B, 7C, 7D, and 7E illustrate various views of an example pet groomer, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

(12) FIG. 8 is a close up view of a handle being connected to a body of the example pet groomer of FIGS. 7A, 7B, 7C, 7D, and 7E, in accordance with the teachings of this disclosure.

DESCRIPTION

(13) FIGS. 1A, 1B, 1C, and 1D illustrate an example pet groomer **100** configured to act as a groomer device and a massaging device based on the configuration of a hand of a user. In the illustrated examples, the pet groomer **100** includes a body **102**, a blade **104**, a handle **106**, and a blade mount **107**. In use, the hand of the user fits through the handle **106** so that one of more fingers are positionable in one portion of the body and a thumb and/or back of the palm is positionable in another portion of the body **102** to position the body **102** in the palm of the hand. The body **102** is flexible and deforms. For example, as illustrated in FIGS. 1A, 1B, 1C, and 1D, the body **102** deforms based on the positioning of the fingers relative the thumb (e.g., the position of the first portion of the body **102** relative to the second portion of the body **102**, etc.). As illustrated in FIG. 1C, when the tips of the fingers are extended away from the thumb and/or the back of the palm (e.g., the main portion of the body **102** is relatively flat), the blade **104** is in a position to contact the coat of a pet companion **108**. This position is sometimes referred to as the “flat position” or the “grooming position.” As illustrated in FIG. 1D, when the tips of the fingers are brought towards the thumb and/or back of the palm (e.g., the main portion of the body **102** is deformed to be curved such that the first portion and the second portion of the body **102** are closer to each other, etc.), the body **102** contacts the pet companion to, for example, provide a massaging surface while the blade **104** is away from the coat of the animal companion. This position is sometimes referred to as the “cupped position” or the “massaging position.”

(14) FIGS. 2A, 2B, 2C, and 2D illustrate various views of the body **102** of a pet groomer **102**. FIG. 2A illustrates a perspective view of the body **102** of a pet groomer **102**. FIG. 2B illustrates a top view of the body **102** of a pet groomer **102**. FIG. 2C illustrates a front view of the body **102** of a pet groomer **102**. FIG. 2D illustrates a side view of the body **102** of a pet groomer **102**. In the illustrated examples, the body **102** includes a main body **202**, wing members **204A** and **204B** (collectively “wing members **204**”), and handle portions **206A** and **206B** (collectively “handle portions **204**”). The body **102** is made of a flexible material (e.g., such as polypropylene) that allows the main body **202** to flex such that the wing members **202** may be brought closer to each other.

(15) The main body **202** is connected the wing members **204**. In the illustrated examples, the main body **202** is connected integrally formed with the wing members **202**. Alternatively, the main body **202** and the wing members **202** may be separate components such that the wing portions **204** attach to the main body **202**. In some such examples, the main body **202** and the wing members **204** may be made of different materials where the main body **202** is made of a flexible material and the wing members **204** are made of a more rigid material. The main body **202** defines handle apertures **208** and mount apertures **210**. The handle apertures **208** are configured to each receive (e.g., via a snap fit, etc.) different ends of the handle **106**. The mount apertures **210** is configured to receive (e.g., via a snap fit, etc.) the blade mount **107**. Alternatively, in some examples, the blade mount **107** may be integrally formed with the main body **202**.

(16) The wing members **204** generally have a semi-circular or semi-ellipsoidal cross section. The wing members **204** are configured such that, when the pet groomer **100** is in the flat position (e.g., the main body **202** is relatively flat), the blade **104** is positioned such that the blade **104** is in contact with the coat of the animal companion to groom the animal companion. Additionally, the wing members **204** are configured such that, when the pet groomer **100** is in the cupped position (e.g., the main body **202** is deformed), the blade **104** is positioned such that the blade **104** is not in contact with the coat of the animal companion while base surfaces **212** of the wing members **204** are in contact with the animal companion.

(17) The handle portions **206** extend from the corresponding wing members **204** on the opposite side of the wing members **204** as the main body **202**. In the illustrated examples, the handle portions **206** are integrally formed with the wing members **204**. When the pet groomer **100** is in the cupped positioned (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 1D), the handle portions **206** may contact the animal companion.

(18) In use, the hand of the user fits through the handle **106** so that one of more fingers are positionable in one wing portion **204A** of the body **102** and a thumb and/or back of the palm is positionable in the other wing portion **204B** to position the body **102** in the palm of the hand. When the tips of the fingers are extended away

from the thumb and/or the back of the palm (e.g., the main portion **202** is relatively flat), the blade **104** is in a position to contact the coat of a pet companion **108**. When the tips of the fingers are brought towards the thumb and/or back of the palm (e.g., the main portion **202** of the body **102** is deformed to be curved such that the wing members **204** are closer to each other, etc.), the wing members **204** and/or the handle portions **206** contact the pet companion to, for example, provide a massaging surface while the blade **104** is away from the coat of the animal companion.

(19) FIGS. **3A**, **3B**, **3C**, **3D**, and **4** illustrate various views of the blade **104** of the pet groomer **100**. FIG. **3A** illustrates a perspective view of the blade **104**. FIG. **3B** illustrates a front view of the blade **104**. FIG. **3C** illustrates a bottom view of the blade **104**. FIG. **3D** illustrates a side view of the blade **104**. FIG. **4** illustrates a comb section **302** defined in a blade surface **304** of the blade **104**. In the illustrated examples, the blade **104** includes protector portions **306** that flank each side of the blade surface **304**. The protector portions **306** prevent and/or inhibit the comb section **302** interfacing with coat when the blade **104** is being moved coplanar with a surface of the blade **104**. In the illustrated example, the blade **104** defines mount apertures **308** to mount (e.g., via a snap fit, etc.) into the blade mount **107**.

(20) FIGS. **5A** and **5B** illustrate the handle **106** of the pet groomer **100**. FIG. **5A** illustrates a top view of the handle **106**. FIG. **5B** illustrates a side view of the handle **106**. The handle **106** is made of a flexible material. The handle **106**, when attached to the body **102**, defines a space through which a hand may be placed to facilitate control of the pet groomer **100**. The handle devices locking tabs **502** that interface (e.g., snap fit into, etc.) the handle apertures **208** of the body **102**.

(21) FIGS. **6A** and **6B** illustrate a pet groomer **600**. In the illustrated example, the main body **202** of the pet groomer **600** is configured to have the orientation of the blade **104** change. In some examples, pet groomer **600** includes a turning element **602** (sometimes referred to as a “dsick”) that is rotatably connected to a corresponding aperture defined in the main body **202**. The turning element **602** may rotate and lock between two settings (e.g., rotate 90 degrees). The first setting positions the blade **104** to be substantially parallel to the wing members **204**. The second setting positions the blade **104** to be substantially perpendicular to the wing members **204**. In some such examples, the blade mount **107** is affixed and/or otherwise attached to the turning element **602**. Alternatively or additionally, in some examples, the main body **202** (or the turning element **602**) may define mounting apertures **604** to facilitate mouthing the blade **104** in a position either parallel to the wing members **204** or perpendicular to the wing members **204**. In some examples, the blade **104** includes stands **606** that lock into (e.g., snap fit) into the mounting apertures **604**. Alternatively, in some examples, the blade **104** may snap into (e.g., via the mount apertures **308**) the blade mount **107** (as described above). The blade mount **107** may include the stands **606** to lock into (e.g., snap fit, friction fit, etc.) into the mounting apertures **604**.

(22) FIGS. **7A**, **7B**, **7C**, **7D**, and **7E** illustrate various views of an example pet groomer **700**. FIG. **7A** illustrates a top perspective view of the pet groomer **700**. FIG. **7B** illustrates a top view of the pet groomer **700**. FIG. **7C** illustrates a bottom perspective view of the pet groomer **700**. FIG. **7D** illustrates a bottom view of the pet groomer **700**. FIG. **7E** illustrates a side view of the pet groomer **700**. The pet groomer **700** is configured such that the blade **104** is repositionable to at least two positions. In some examples, the pet groomer **700** is configurable between a parallel position where the blade is substantially parallel with the wing members **204** and an offset position where the blade **104** is positioned a predetermined number of degrees (e.g., 30 degrees, 45 degrees, 60 degrees). As best illustrated in FIGS. **7C** and **7D**, in the illustrated example, the blade **104** is rotated 45 degrees relative the wing members **204** in the offset position.

(23) The pet groomer **700** includes the main body **202**, the wing members **204** and the handle portions **206**. The main body **202** defines handle holes **702** and position holes **704A**, **704B**, and **704C** (collectively the “position holes **704**”). The position holes **704** are located on the main body **202** to accept the blade mount **107** in the parallel position and the offset position. In the illustrated example, the main body **202** defines a central position hole **704A**. The main body **202** also defines the parallel position holes **704B** that, in conjunction with the central position hole **704A**, facilitate receiving the blade mount **107** in the parallel position. The main body **202** also defines offset position holes **704C** that, in conjunction with the central position hole **704A**, facilitate receiving the blade mount **107** in the offset position.

(24) In the illustrated example, the blade mount **107** includes the stands **606** to lock into (e.g., snap fit, friction fit, etc.) into the position holes **704**. The blade **104** may snap into (e.g., via the mount apertures **308**) the blade mount **107**.

(25) A handle **706** of FIGS. **7A-7E** (sometimes referred to as a “strap”) is configured to, on each end, feed through the corresponding handle hole **702** and then be fastened. The handle **706** is made of a flexible

material. As best illustrated in FIG. 8, on each end, the handle 706 defines one or more snap holes 708. Rivets 710 formed on a body 712 of the handle 706 are configured to lock into (e.g., snap fit, friction fit, etc.) the corresponding snap holes 708. In such a manner, the handle 706 may be secured to the main body 202.

(26) Although the embodiments of this disclosure have been illustrated in the accompanying drawings and described in the foregoing detailed description, it is to be understood that the present disclosure is not to be limited to just the described embodiments, but that the embodiments described herein are capable of numerous rearrangements, modifications and substitutions without departing from the scope of the claims hereafter. It is, of course, not possible to describe every conceivable combination of components or methodologies for purposes of describing the present specification, but one of ordinary skill in the art may recognize that many further combinations and permutations of the present specification are possible. Each of the components described above may be combined or added together in any permutation to define an introducing device and/or introducing system. Accordingly, the present specification is intended to embrace all such alterations, modifications and variations that fall within the spirit and scope of the appended claims. Furthermore, to the extent that the term “includes” is used in either the detailed description or the claims, such term is intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprising” as “comprising” is interpreted when employed as a transitional word in a claim. The claims as follows are intended to include all modifications and alterations insofar as they come within the scope of the claims or the equivalent thereof.

Claims

1. A grooming mount comprising: a body made of a deformable material configured to deform between a first position and a second position; wing members, each of the wing members connected to opposite sides of the body, the body defining a first distance between the wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position, wherein the wing members are formed of a first material that is stiffer than a second material from which the body is formed; a blade holder connected to the body; and a grooming blade fixed to the blade holder, wherein the grooming blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position as the grooming blade is spaced from the body, wherein the blade holder is integrally formed with the body, wherein the body is positionable in a palm of a user's hand and wherein the grooming mount is selectively transitionable between the first position and the second position based on a configuration of the user's hand.
2. The grooming mount of claim 1, wherein the wing members are integrally formed with the body.
3. The grooming mount of claim 1, wherein the body defines a turning element, and wherein the turning element defines a set of mounting holes.
4. The grooming mount of claim 3, wherein the turning element is rotatable relative to the body.
5. A grooming tool comprising: a grooming blade configured to groom a coat of an animal; a grooming mount comprising: a body made of a deformable material configured to deform between a first position and a second position; wing members, the body defining a first distance between in wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position, wherein the wing members are integrally formed with the body and wherein the wing members are formed of a first material that is stiffer than a second material from which the body is formed; and a blade holder connected to the body configured to affix to the grooming blade, wherein the grooming blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position as the grooming blade is not in contact with a coat of the animal and wherein the grooming tool is configured to provide massage in the second position; and a handle configured to receive a hand, the handle affixed to the grooming mount.
6. The grooming tool of claim 5, wherein the blade holder is integrally formed with the body.
7. The grooming tool of claim 5, wherein the body defines a first plurality of mounting holes and wherein the blade holder detachably connects to the body via stands configured to lock into the first plurality of mounting holes.
8. The grooming tool of claim 7, wherein the body defines a second plurality of mounting holes, the first plurality of mounting holes and the second set plurality of mounting holes having a hole in common.
9. The grooming tool of claim 8, wherein the first plurality of mounting holes and the second plurality of mounting holes each define a line and wherein the line defined by the first plurality of mounting holes is rotationally offset from the line defined by the second plurality of mounting holes.
10. The grooming tool of claim 5, wherein the body defines a turning element, and wherein the turning element defines a plurality of mounting holes.

11. The grooming tool of claim 10, wherein the turning element is rotatable relative to the body.
 12. The grooming tool of claim 5, wherein the grooming blade defines a plurality of mounting apertures, wherein the blade mount is configured to couple to the blade via the mounting apertures.
 13. The grooming tool of claim 5, wherein the grooming blade comprises a comb section.
 14. A grooming mount comprising: a body made of a deformable material configured to deform between a first position and a second position; wing members, each of the wing members connected to opposite sides of the body, the body defining a first distance between the wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position, wherein the wing members are formed of a first material that is stiffer than a second material from which the body is formed; a grooming blade; and a blade holder connected to the body, wherein the grooming blade is affixed to the blade holder, and wherein the grooming blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position as the grooming blade is not in contact with a coat of an animal, wherein the grooming mount is configured to provide massage in the second position, wherein the body defines a turning element, and wherein the turning element defines a plurality of mounting holes.
 15. The grooming mount of claim 14, wherein the turning element is rotatable relative to the body.
 16. A grooming mount comprising: a body made of a deformable material configured to deform between a first position and a second position; wing members, each of the wing members connected to opposite sides of the body, the body defining a first distance between the wing members in the first position and a second, shorter distance in the second position, wherein the wing members are formed of a first material that is stiffer than a second material from which the body is formed; a blade holder connected to the body; and a grooming blade affixed to the blade holder, wherein the grooming blade is positioned to groom when the body is in the first position and is not in a position to groom when the body is in the second position as the grooming blade is not in contact with a coat of an animal, wherein the grooming mount is configured to provide massage in the second position, wherein the body defines a first plurality of mounting holes and wherein the blade holder detachably connects to the body via stands configured to lock into the first plurality of mounting holes.
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